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Artefact — Recruitment

Re: Forward Deployed Engineer — Utrecht

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Forward deployed is the only way I have ever worked. At Netvice, a Tilburg contact-centre company, nobody handed me requirements: I sat with the people doing the work, found where the process actually broke, and then built the thing that fixed it. That produced a real-time operations layer wired to telephony webhooks, a daily planner used on the floor, and a forecasting model that turns planned volume into the exact headcount needed on any future day, 500+ days ahead. Each one began as my own proposal and ended in daily production use — and I moved from data intern to Data & Process Analyst working with progressively more senior stakeholders, ending on strategic projects with the founder.

On your two tracks, honestly: my strength is the AI/LLM side. I build with agentic tooling daily — Claude Code and Replit are my delivery method, not an experiment — and my own SaaS, Citania, is roughly 80,000 lines of production TypeScript on PostgreSQL with 294 automated tests and contract-first OpenAPI/Zod schemas. On the data-platform side I write Python and SQL and have built ETL from APIs and webhooks into Postgres end to end, but I have not run Airflow or dbt in production, and my cloud experience is working rather than certified. I would rather you know that now than discover it in week two.

The consulting half is what attracts me. My degrees are economics and data science, so translating between a business problem and a technical one is the part I actually enjoy — and it is what made the Netvice work land at all. Clients like KLM, Rabobank and ASML are exactly the environments where that translation decides whether a model gets used or shelved.

A practical note: I am a non-EU national holding a Dutch highly-skilled-migrant permit, so Artefact Benelux — a recognised IND sponsor — would need to take over the sponsorship. Utrecht is an easy commute from Tilburg. Everything I have described is live and clickable at franciscorau.com, and I would gladly walk your team through the forecasting model or the Citania codebase.

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